

Ian Salandy

Principal Software Architect | Performance and Reliability Engineering Leader
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SUMMARY

Principal-level architect with 15+ years of experience leading performance, scalability, and reliability engineering for large-scale distributed systems. Expert in designing high-throughput data platforms, backend infrastructure, and system-level optimization strategies for multi-billion event workloads. Proven ability to define architectural direction, influence cross-team engineering decisions, and improve system efficiency, cost, and reliability. Recognized for building frameworks, diagnostics, and predictive models that identify bottlenecks and prevent failures before they occur.

CORE STRENGTHS

Distributed Systems Architecture & Platform Design
Performance Engineering & System Optimization
Reliability Engineering & Failure Mode Analysis
High-Throughput Data Platforms (Spark, Trino, Kafka)
Capacity Planning & Predictive Workload Modeling
Observability, Telemetry & Diagnostics Strategy
Cloud Infrastructure (AWS, Kubernetes, EMR, EKS)
Cross-Team Technical Leadership & Architecture Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Salesforce — Acting Principal Architect / Staff Performance Engineer (2021 – Present)

- Defined performance and scalability architecture for distributed data platforms processing billions of events annually.
- Led cross-team initiatives improving system throughput by 35% and reducing infrastructure cost by 25%.
- Designed system-level optimization strategies across compute, storage, and query execution layers.
- Built predictive workload models to guide capacity planning and scaling decisions.
- Established telemetry-driven diagnostics frameworks for identifying bottlenecks and preventing regressions.
- Influenced architecture decisions across multiple teams, improving platform-wide reliability and efficiency.
- Mentored engineers and drove adoption of performance engineering best practices across the organization.

IBM — Principal Performance & Capacity Engineer (2016 – 2021)

- Led performance and capacity engineering initiatives for distributed enterprise platforms.
- Designed system-level scaling models and infrastructure optimization strategies.
- Improved backend system latency and stability through JVM tuning and architectural optimization.
- Developed tooling and frameworks for performance diagnostics and regression detection.

Accenture — Lead Performance Engineer (2009 – 2016)

- Led performance and scalability initiatives for large-scale enterprise systems.
- Designed load simulation frameworks to validate system behavior under high concurrency.
- Diagnosed and resolved critical system performance issues across distributed architectures.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Improved distributed system throughput by 35% across large-scale data platforms
- Reduced infrastructure cost by \$750K+ annually through system-level optimization
- Enabled reliable processing of billions of events in distributed systems
- Prevented production failures through predictive workload modeling and diagnostics

TECHNOLOGIES

Java, Python, SQL

Spark, Trino/Presto, Kafka

Kubernetes, AWS, EMR, EKS

Distributed systems design, workload modeling, performance optimization

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science — North Carolina State University

B.S. Computer Science — Morehouse College